

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6

♥ 7 2

♦ 6 5 4 3 2

♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A Q 10 9 4 3

♦ -

♣ 8 7 4



♠ 7 3

♥ 8 6 5

♦ Q J 10 9 7

♣ A Q 3

♠ A J 8 5

♥ K J

♦ A K 8

♣ K J 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♠

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♥7

South opens 2NT.

Wow! Start thinking slam, but first things first. Find the suit by starting with Stayman. You bid 3♣ and partner replies 3♠. What do you say next?

Your hand revalues to 16 points now that you know there's a ♠ fit. So certainly you want to be in slam as long as there are not two quick ♣ losers. At this point you might try something like a 4♦ cue bid, hoping partner will read that as a slam try in ♠s, but denying the ♣ control. But that seems awfully easy to be misunderstood. We suggest an immediate 6♠.

Good thing it's being played by South, right?

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 6
 ♥ 7 5 2
 ♦ 10 4
 ♣ A K 10 5 3

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ J 8 7 6 3

♣ -

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5
 ♥ Q J
 ♦ A K 9
 ♣ J 9 6 4 2

♠ A 8 3

♥ A K 6 4

♦ Q 5 2

♣ Q 8 7

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
All Pass			
2♥ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

South opens 1NT.

Your first thought should be that with only 4 points you will pass. But on second thought, what would partner respond if you bid a Stayman 2♣? So you give it a shot and partner says 2♥. What next?

What's next is your PASS. And if he had bid 2♠ you also would have passed. And if he had bid 2♦ you also would have passed. You figured that with this hand any response partner could make would be a better place than 1NT.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 4 2
♥ Q 10 8 7 3
♦ A 10 6 3
♣ 6 3

♠ Q J 8 5

♥ K 6 4

♦ Q J 7

♣ K 10 8



♠ A K 7 3

♥ A 9 5

♦ 9 8 2

♣ A Q 2

♠ 10 9 6

♥ J 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ J 9 7 5 4

South opens 1NT.

With 12 points and a 4-card ♠ suit this fits the model for Stayman.

But thinking a little further, with this 4-3-3-3 distribution you have no ruffing values whatsoever. So even if partner also has 4 ♠s there might not be an advantage in playing the suit contract. So for this specific distribution you ignore your 4-card Major and just bid 3NT.

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥7			

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 3
 ♥ 9 8 6 5 3
 ♦ K 8 6 2
 ♣ 6 3 2

♠ A Q 10 6

♥ Q 7

♦ 10 9 5

♣ K 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 7 5 4 2

♥ A 10 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J

♠ 9 8

♥ K J 4

♦ A Q J 7

♣ A 10 8 5

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	2♠	Pass
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠ 3			

After you open 1NT partner bids 2♣, then East says 2♠. What do you say next?

Basically you said your say when you opened 1NT. You don't have a 4-card Major and you have a minimum hand. The best way to convey this information to partner is to pass. At which point partner jumps to 3NT.

Pass, then "Thank you partner" when dummy comes down. The thing to remember is that partner is in charge. You describe your hand as well as you can and then sit back and let him make the decisions. Perhaps you would have doubled if you held his hand but he didn't.